

PETRU RAREȘ 1259



Why is this project a best practice?

Challenge

The project addresses the difficulty of scaling low-energy and healthy-building principles beyond a single dwelling. It had to combine density or phased delivery with reliable energy performance, good indoor conditions, landscape quality, mobility and construction cost, while keeping the sustainability measures practical for many future occupants.

Solution

The response combines a contemporary interpretation of the area's industrial character using robust façade systems and a strong internal courtyard; a mix of apartment sizes arranged to maximise daylight and urban views on a constrained central site; and Green Homes criteria applied alongside architecture-led regeneration near Gara de Nord and major public transport. These measures were brought together through an integrated design approach and, where applicable, the Green Homes, nZEB or Passive House performance framework.

Replicability

The approach can be scaled through repeatable specifications for envelope, MEP systems, materials, commissioning, mobility and landscape. Replication is strongest when the developer applies the same measurable requirements to every phase and verifies them at handover, rather than treating certification as a one-off design exercise.

Key facts and figures

Location	Strada Petru Rareș 5-9, Bucharest, Romania
Building use / function	Urban multi-family residential development
Project type (new build, refurbishment, extension)	New build; phased infill development

Plot area / Floor area	First phase reported at approximately 95 dwellings; exact certified floor area not publicly disclosed
Year / phase	Design awards reported in 2020-2022; phased delivery
Climate zone	Temperate continental
Thematic focus / innovation	Industrial-site reinterpretation; courtyard daylight; durable façade; urban regeneration; Green Homes certification
Investor / building owner	Global Invest
Architect	Fabrica de Arhitectură
Other involved stakeholders	Hope Project SRL (structure); Aluminios Cortizo Romania and façade specialists; Romania Green Building Council
Contact person	Global Invest / project developer; no named public contact identified
Further information	https://www.roghbc.org/proiecte-certificate-roghbc?lang=en https://www.roghbc.org/_files/ugd/40ee3e_b5d91d7a3b71422cb98cd7a289b89c79.pdf https://www.anuala.ro/proiecte/2022/221/

Petru Rareș 1259 is a new build; phased infill development project in Strada Petru Rareș 5-9, Bucharest, Romania. It functions as urban multi-family residential development. Its main best-practice contribution is Combines award-recognised architecture with a certified sustainability framework in a difficult urban-infill context. The documented strategy brings together a contemporary interpretation of the area's industrial character using robust façade systems and a strong internal courtyard, a mix of apartment sizes arranged to maximise daylight and urban views on a constrained central site, and Green Homes criteria applied alongside architecture-led regeneration near Gara de Nord and major public transport. Public sources describe multiple phases and 95 homes in the first phase; final totals should be checked with the developer. Public-source research was reviewed in July 2026; data that vary by phase are explicitly flagged in this sheet.

What was done differently?

1. Performance concept - A contemporary interpretation of the area's industrial character using robust façade systems and a strong internal courtyard.
2. Integrated systems and operation - A mix of apartment sizes arranged to maximise daylight and urban views on a constrained central site.
3. Wider value - Green homes criteria applied alongside architecture-led regeneration near gara de nord and major public transport.

What was achieved?

Impact

Environmental impact: The project reduces energy and associated emissions primarily by lowering demand and then using efficient or renewable systems. Its material, landscape, waste or mobility measures add benefits beyond operational energy where documented. A verified whole-life carbon assessment was not publicly available, so the impact is described qualitatively unless a source provides a specific figure.

Economic impact: Lower energy demand can reduce utility exposure and improve long-term operating-cost predictability. Standardised high-performance specifications and third-party certification can also support quality assurance, market value and access to green-

finance products. Public sources do not provide a complete investment, payback or life-cycle-cost analysis for this project.

Social impact: The main social benefits are stable indoor temperatures, better air quality, daylight and acoustic comfort, together with safer and more attractive shared or outdoor spaces where these form part of the project. The project also raises market awareness by making high-performance housing visible to residents, designers, contractors and investors.

Key Learnings

Success factors: Key success factors are an integrated design process, a clear performance framework, early coordination of envelope and building services, selection of competent suppliers, quality control during construction and commissioning. Transparent documentation and communication with occupants are essential to preserve the intended performance in use.

Lessons for replication: Replication should start with an energy and comfort target, not a catalogue of technologies. Design teams should verify thermal bridges, airtightness, ventilation, controls and renewable sizing together; record assumptions by project phase; commission systems; and monitor early operation. Where public figures differ by phase, the final as-built dataset must become the single source of truth.